

GL!TCH — Diagnostic Sprint

Forecast · Residencies · 3 weeks embedded

A 3-week embedded residency to diagnose where the real bottleneck lives before anyone writes code.

The three journeys

Narrative. You stopped building the wrong thing. The three weeks of diagnosis saved six months of shipping.

Cognitive. Diagnosis > prototype > production. Every symptom is mapped to a root before any solution is drawn.

Identity. From feature-shipper to root-cause diagnostician.

Curriculum by module

Module 1 — Week 1 — Landing

40h · Love — Why this matters

Outcome: No-blame contract signed.

Intent: Establish shared understanding of what the org is protecting.

Prompt question: What is this org afraid the diagnosis will find?

Exercise	Time	Prompt	Debrief
Stakeholder Fears	150m	One 30-min interview each. Only question: 'What are you afraid we'll find?'	Cluster fears. Publish the fear map.
The No-Blame Contract	45m	Draft and co-sign a 1-page no-blame diagnostic contract.	Read aloud in the kickoff. Post to Slack.
Success Definition	60m	Facilitated session: 'A successful diagnosis is one that ____.'	Convert to 5 measurable success criteria.

Artifact: A signed no-blame contract. A fear map. Success criteria.

Module 2 — Week 1-2 — Symptom map

30h · Magic — The reframe

Outcome: Symptom wall + roots.

Intent: Show that symptoms are almost never the problem.

Prompt question: Which symptom has been hiding the actual problem?

Exercise	Time	Prompt	Debrief
Symptom Wall	240m	One week of Slack, tickets, meeting notes. Every complaint → sticky note.	Cluster. Ask: 'Which cluster surprises you?'
Root Trace	90m	Pick 3 symptoms. Ask 'why' 5 times each.	Present to leadership. Note their reaction.
The False-	30m	List 3 things everyone treats as	Circulate to leadership. Ask for

Problem List		problems that aren't.	pushback.
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Artifact: A clustered symptom wall. A root-trace document. A false-problem list.

Module 3 — Week 2 — Grid score

20h · Calm — Organize complexity

Outcome: 5-page diagnostic v1.

Intent: Introduce the diagnostic framework: 5-season × 5-state grid.

Prompt question: In which season and which state does this org break?

Exercise	Time	Prompt	Debrief
The Grid Score	180m	For each cell: 1-5 score with 1-line evidence.	Present to leadership as diagnostic.
Missing Cell Interview	240m	Book 3 more interviews around that cell.	Ask: 'What does this cell need to become a 3?'
The Diagnostic Report	480m	One page per season. State score per cell. Root cause per season.	Circulate. Get one leader signature per season.

Artifact: A scored grid. A 5-page diagnostic report.

Module 4 — Week 3 — Read-out

20h · Open — Pattern discovery

Outcome: Public v2 diagnostic.

Intent: Present findings and let the org argue with them.

Prompt question: What did we get wrong in our diagnosis?

Exercise	Time	Prompt	Debrief
The Findings Read-Out	90m	90-min read-out. 30 min findings, 60 min pushback.	Log every pushback verbatim.
Pushback Integration	240m	Integrate top 5 pushbacks. Publish v2.	Ask: 'Which pushback changed the diagnosis?'
The Public Wall	60m	Print. Post in the largest common space.	Note who stops to read. Talk to them.

Artifact: A pushback log. A v2 diagnostic. A public-wall photo.

Module 5 — Week 3 — Bet

10h · Free — Commitment

Outcome: One-page bet signed.

Intent: Recommend one — and only one — thing.

Prompt question: What is the smallest thing that would unblock everything else?

Exercise	Time	Prompt	Debrief
The One Recommendation	90m	One page: recommendation, rationale, cost, undo condition.	Present to leadership. No slides.
The Bet Contract	45m	Sign a 1-page bet: recommendation	Post the bet to the team.

		→ success metric → 90-day check.	
Handoff to Prototype	90m	Draft the 1-page brief for the next residency.	Handoff meeting with the next team.

Artifact: A one-page recommendation. A signed bet. A prototype brief.

Commitment contract

What one thing will this org bet on based on this diagnostic?

Based on this diagnostic, _____ will bet on _____ by _____. The success metric is _____. The undo condition is _____.

Witness — One member of the executive team.